December, closed day by day.

Three pages: the close day by day, the year-end extras, and a timetable with an owner beside every step. 1 January 2027 is a public holiday (Ministry of Manpower), so day 1 is Monday 4 January.

01 The close, day by day

WHEN	WHAT GETS DONE	DONE WHEN
Before month end Mon 21 to Thu 31 Dec	Remind sales to hand in every delivery note and staff to submit claims. Chase supplier invoices for goods already received. Fix the stock count date and the cut-off time. Send everyone the timetable on page 3.	Each person knows their step and day
Day 1 Mon 4 Jan	Cut-off: write down December's last invoice, receipt and delivery numbers. Save statements to 31 Dec for every account.	Numbers written; statements saved
Day 2 Tue 5 Jan	Reconcile every bank account. Each unmatched line gets an owner. Deliveries made but not invoiced are invoiced or listed.	Bank agrees to the books; list explained
Day 3 Wed 6 Jan	Match supplier statements for the ten largest suppliers. List goods received but not invoiced, and accrue them.	Ten matched; accruals totalled
Day 4 Thu 7 Jan	Post the stock count differences and review slow items. Post payroll, CPF and the recurring entries: depreciation, prepayments, loan interest.	Stock agrees to count; payroll to bank
Day 5 Fri 8 Jan	Review margin by product line against last month and last December. Explain anything odd in one line. Send the reports.	Reports sent; slowest step noted

Five days is a target, not a rule. If your close takes twelve days today, aim for ten in January.

02 What your close costs

Close cost for a year = people × hours a day × days per close × 12 × hourly cost.
Worked example (example figures): 3 people × 4 hours a day × 9 days × 12 closes = **1,296 hours**. At S$35 an hour that is **S$45,360 a year**.

The same sum at 5 days: 3 × 4 × 5 × 12 = **720 hours**, or S$25,200. The gap is 576 hours and **S$20,160** a year. The larger cost is not in the sum: January decisions made on November's numbers.

How a close gets shorter

1. **Every step has one owner and one cover.** "Accounts" is not an owner. A name is. 2. **A step is done when its test is met,** not when someone says it is nearly there. 3. **Write down the step that waited longest.** Next month, start that step one day earlier, or remove what it was waiting for. One step a month is enough.

03 What December adds to a normal close

A normal month needs page 1. December needs six more things, because these are the numbers other people will read: your directors, your bank, your auditor, your tax agent.

A Cut-off numbers

The last sales invoice, delivery order, goods receipt, credit note and payment voucher of 2026, on one signed sheet. Then check five documents either side of each: is every one in the right year?

B Stock count tie-in

The count sheets, the cut-off numbers used on the day, and every movement between the count date and 31 Dec if you counted early. The count total must agree to the stock figure in the books, with each difference explained.

C Accruals

Costs of 2026 not yet invoiced: bonus and unused leave, commissions, utilities, freight, professional fees, goods received but not invoiced. One line each, with how the amount was worked out.

D Supplier statements

Ask every major supplier for a statement at 31 Dec. Match each one to your records and list the differences: invoices in transit, payments in transit, disputes.

E Fixed assets list

Additions with their invoices. Disposals taken off. Items no longer in use marked. Walk the floor once and tick each large item: is it still there, and still used?

F What your auditor or tax agent asks for first

From experience: the trial balance. Bank statements and reconciliations at 31 Dec. Aged customer and supplier lists that agree to the books. Count sheets and the final stock list. The fixed assets list. A payroll summary that agrees to CPF. Loan statements. The accruals list. Put them in one folder before anyone asks.

04 What a late December close holds up

Four dated things wait on December's numbers. Each is quoted from the official page named beside it.

DATE	WHAT THE OFFICIAL PAGE SAYS	SOURCE
Thu 14 Jan	CPF for December wages is due on 31 Dec. Enforcement applies to employers who have not paid by the 14th of the following month.	CPF Board
Tue 26 Jan	A company files its ECI within 3 months of its year end, unless the waiver applies. With a December year-end and GIRO, it gets 10 instalments if it files by 26 Jan, 8 by 26 Feb and 6 by 26 Mar.	IRAS, ECI filing
Sun 31 Jan	The GST return and payment for October to December are due. The page states no weekend roll-over for filing.	IRAS, GST due dates
Mon 1 Mar	Employers in the Auto-Inclusion Scheme submit employment income records by 1 Mar each year.	IRAS, AIS

Read on the official pages on 11 Nov 2026; the days of the week are my own calendar arithmetic. Your tax agent decides what applies to your company.

Free tool for this, at tools.gantry.work: a month-end close cost calculator. Put in your own people, hours and days.

05 December 2026 close timetable

Write one name in Owner and one in Cover for every step. Change the dates if your day 1 is different. Tick Done only when the test on page 1 is met.

WHEN	DATE	STEP	OWNER	COVER	DONE
BEFORE	21 to 31 Dec	Delivery notes and staff claims handed in			
BEFORE	21 to 31 Dec	Supplier invoices chased for goods received			
BEFORE	By 31 Dec	Stock counted; cut-off numbers written down			
DAY 1	Mon 4 Jan	December's last document numbers noted			
DAY 1	Mon 4 Jan	All bank statements to 31 Dec saved			
DAY 2	Tue 5 Jan	Banks reconciled; unmatched lines assigned			
DAY 2	Tue 5 Jan	Uninvoiced deliveries: invoiced or listed			
DAY 3	Wed 6 Jan	Supplier statements matched, ten largest			
DAY 3	Wed 6 Jan	Goods received not invoiced: listed, accrued			
DAY 3	Wed 6 Jan	Accruals: bonus, leave, fees, utilities			
DAY 4	Thu 7 Jan	Count differences posted; slow items reviewed			
DAY 4	Thu 7 Jan	Payroll, CPF and recurring entries posted			
DAY 4	Thu 7 Jan	Fixed assets list updated and walked			
DAY 5	Fri 8 Jan	Margins reviewed: last month, last December			
DAY 5	Fri 8 Jan	Reports sent; year-end folder complete			
AFTER	The close really finished on (day, date):		The step that waited longest:		

Want a second pair of eyes on your close?

Send me last month's close timeline: who did what, on which day. A few lines in a message are enough, and no figures are needed. Within 48 working hours you get **one page back**: a timetable with one owner per step, and the step that waits longest, with a 5-minute recording that talks you through it. Free, and no pitch unless you ask for one. **Message me CLOSE PLAN on LinkedIn.**